

Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

LLB and LLM graduate with a year's practical experience supporting complex litigation and international arbitration at BCLP, followed by ongoing legal advisory work at Citizens Advice. Experienced in document review, preparing hearing bundles, drafting procedural documents, conducting legal research, and maintaining organised case files under competing deadlines. Comfortable handling sensitive client matters and translating complex legal issues into clear, practical guidance. Seeking a paralegal role in a disputes-focused firm where there is scope for genuine responsibility and progression to a training contract.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution procedure, legal research and evidence analysis
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democracy) — 75%
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions

Law LLB — 2:1

Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Modules included Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law and Company Law

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations

Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead

July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Manages matters from client instruction to submission: takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies, identifies relevant legal and evidential issues
- Drafts correspondence, prepares procedural documents and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines across a varied caseload
- Assesses complex eligibility questions against statutory criteria; researches and advises on welfare benefits, employment, housing, family, debt and consumer matters
- Translates complicated procedural rules into clear, practical guidance for vulnerable clients

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the claimant's memorial in a complex investment arbitration
- Drafted procedural histories and procedural orders; amended sections of the memorial under partner and associate supervision
- Became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a significant submission deadline: coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time filing
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines throughout the matter
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated Romanian translations with an external translator

- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Prepared electronic hearing bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials for contested hearings
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines using iManage
- Assisted with court filings, hearing logistics, matter opening and closure, deadline tracking and cost comparisons
- Prepared client-facing notes and maintained matter records throughout

Q-Legal · London

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to a formal written advice letter under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations, including children's personal data and adtech, and identified compliance risks with recommended mitigations
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice; coordinated with client and supervising solicitor to meet deadline

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis; concise legal drafting; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Evidence review, electronic hearing bundles, procedural histories, case-file organisation, deadline tracking across competing matters